

WHY-WHAT

PRIMARY WHY · SECONDARY WHAT · TERTIARY HOW

How the WHY-WHAT communicates

How your wiring shows up in writing and speech, how each orientation hears it, and the three adjustments that buy the most understanding.

HOW YOU NATURALLY WRITE

Your messages open with meaning and end in motion. You set context, name the opportunity, and land on next steps, purpose and progress in one arc. The ask usually arrives with its reason attached. What thins out is the mechanics: caveats, precise numbers, boundary conditions, the maintenance questions. You spend words where your energy lives, and your reader can feel both the presence and the absence.

Your signature

PRESENT

- + Purpose and vision language: “the opportunity”, “what if”, “the bigger picture”
- + Future mood and possibility; analogies come naturally
- + Next steps, owners, and momentum verbs close the message
- + Subject lines that open thematic and end operational

CONSPICUOUSLY ABSENT

- Qualifiers and conditionals: “assuming”, “unless”, “depends”
- Edge cases, failure modes, and maintenance questions
- Precise numbers; yours tend to arrive round
- The boundary question: “what happens when X?”

HOW YOU LAND

WHY readers

Hear a native speaker. Your framing energizes them, and alignment comes cheap.

WHAT readers

Mostly with you, but they will skim your context hunting for the ask. They wish it came sooner.

HOW readers

Hear inspiration without verification. The missing mechanism reads as unexamined risk, and your certainty can land as naivety about the details.

THE BLIND SPOT

The absence is louder than you think. To a HOW reader, a plan with no caveats does not read as strong, it reads as untested. The trust you lose is not about the idea, it is about whether the idea has met reality. One paragraph of named unknowns buys more credibility with precision wiring than any amount of vision.

For HOW readers

Add the mechanics block. Close with a short section: how it works, what depends on what, and what is not yet verified. Naming the unknowns is the move, it signals the picture has been examined.

For WHAT readers

Promote the ask. Your conclusion lives at the end; move it to line one and compress the context to one sentence. They will read the vision after they know what you want.

Everywhere

Trade round numbers for real ones. “About fifty” reads as unexamined to half your audience. Use the real figure, or say “estimate, will confirm by Friday”. Precision in small places licenses your big claims.